# 6.3

# billion dollars stolen in one evening.

The largest crypto theft ever. **What happened, how it was possible, where the money went.**

Swipe →

**Teodoro Corbo**
Updated 30 October 2026

# The world’s largest crypto exchange.

### Cold wallet

The safe: offline, it holds most of the funds.

### Hot wallet

The till: online, for everyday withdrawals.

← HIT HERE

CLAIMED

Binance says it will cover all user losses and has already set aside **$6.34 billion**. The proof of reserves will tell.

Sources: Elliptic (“the world's largest cryptoasset exchange”), Binance, Security Incident Update #2.

# More than 4 times the previous record.

**$6.43 bn**

Binance · October 2026

**$1.46 bn**

Bybit · 2025

> “Almost certainly the largest single theft of any kind in history.”

Elliptic · square area proportional to the value stolen. Binance puts the impact at about $6.3 bn.

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# 3 hours. 11 blockchains.

**20:05** **First unauthorized withdrawals** from Binance hot wallets.

**20:20** A Binance wallet signs **50 authorizations** prepared by the attacker.

**20:24** **$2.53 billion** leaves in a single transaction.

**~20:25** In about 15 minutes the total hits **$4.9 billion**.

**20:41** A second wallet drained: **$780 million** in USDC.

**21:01** **Tether freezes** the first stolen funds.

**23:05** Last wave, on Avalanche and Polygon.

Sources: Arkham, Elliptic, TRM Labs, Etherscan.

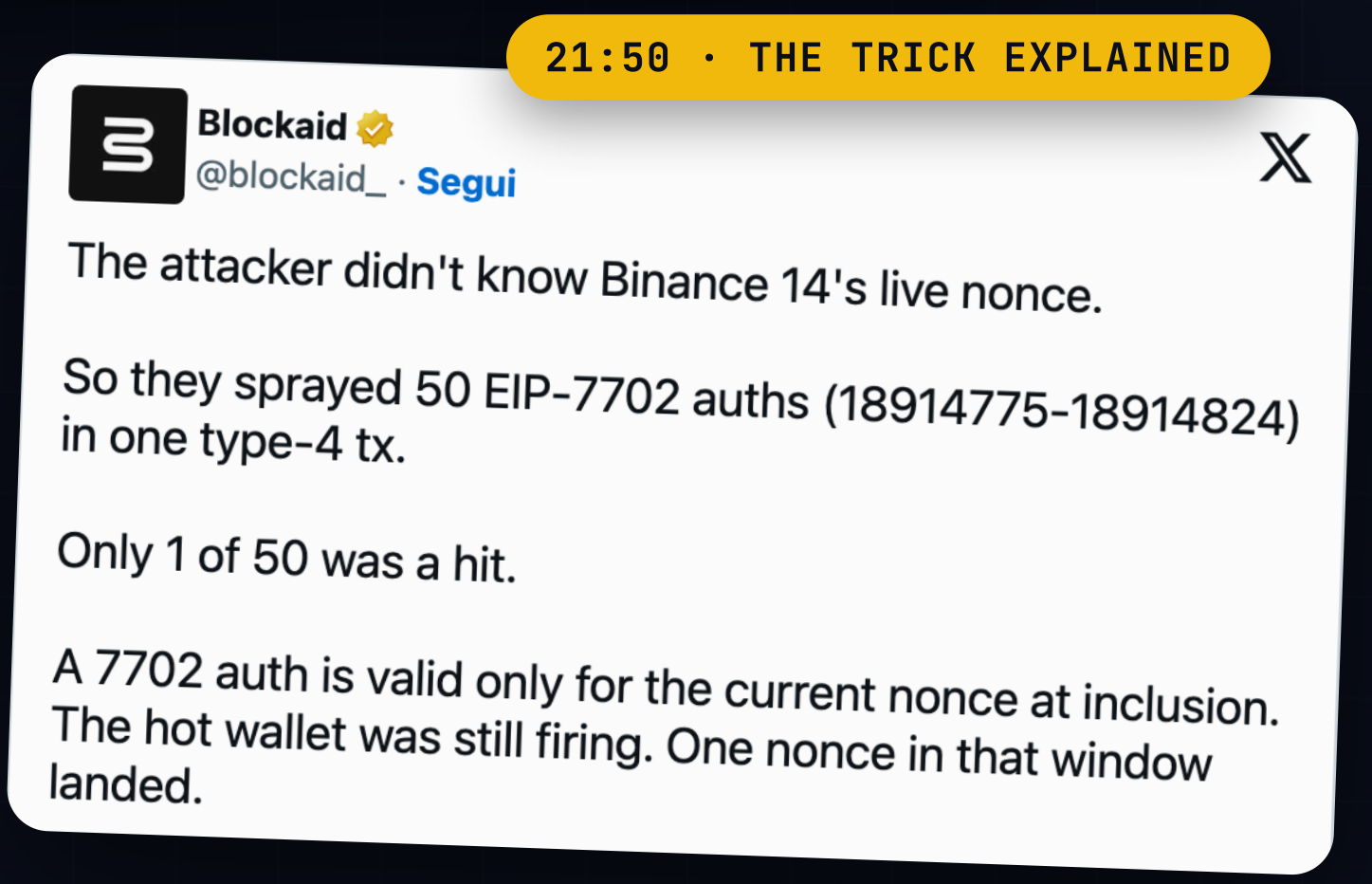
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# Pieced together live.

20:32 · THE FIRST ALARM




21:50 · THE TRICK EXPLAINED




Independent analysts figured out what was going on **hours before the official statements.**

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# They didn’t steal the key. They took over the stamp office.

~~**Key theft**~~

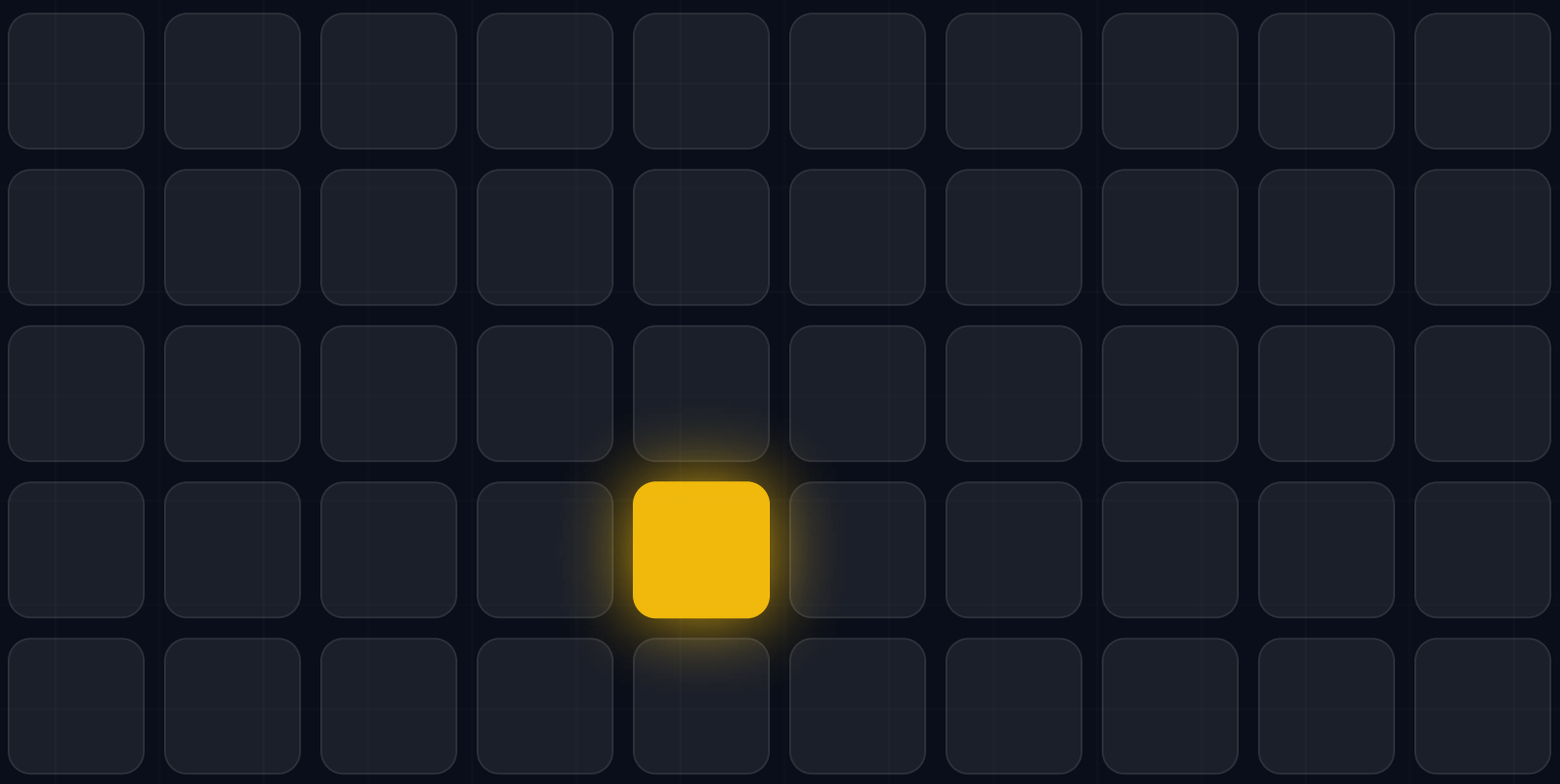
The thief copies the key to the safe and opens it himself.

## Control of the signing system

Every Binance withdrawal has to be “stamped”. The attacker's requests came out stamped: **for the blockchain they were valid.**

Binance says it found no evidence of a private key leak. Sources: TRM Labs, Blockaid, Elliptic, Binance.

# 50 signatures. Only one valid.




The delegation only works with the wallet's exact counter. The attacker didn't know it: **they had 50 signed, and one hit the mark.**

**3' 24"** later, a single withdrawal takes **$2.53 billion.**

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# Almost half was blocked. The rest wasn't.




**45%**
frozen by Tether, Circle and other issuers

**15%**
converted by the attacker into ETH and TRX, before the freezes

**40%**
still in the stolen form: BTC, ETH, XRP, SOL cannot be blocked

The first freezes came **37 minutes** after the main hit. The attacker is left with about **$3.5 billion**.

Based on Arkham data, values at the time of the theft. Sources: Elliptic, TRM Labs.

# Three lessons for anyone holding digital assets.

1

## Cryptography held.

People and processes around the signatures gave way.

2

## Whoever controls who signs, controls the funds.

The signing system must be protected like the money it moves.

3

## Only what has an issuer can be blocked.

For everything else, speed counts: every minute is worth millions.

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# What we still don’t know.

01 **Who really signed?**

Binance mentions “further breach points”, without saying which.

02 **Who’s behind it?**

Analysts point to North Korea. No official confirmation.

03 **Where will $3.5 billion end up?**

Bitcoin, ether and the other unblockable assets are still moving.

04 **Will Binance really cover everything?**

It promised to: the proof of reserves and the post-mortem will tell.

# That was the short version.




## The answers we have so far are in the full analysis. PDF in the first comment (in Italian).

Put in order with a bit of patience and some help from Claude.
If something doesn't add up, comment below or send me a DM.

Teo